

CUDDLES CHILDMINDERS AND SCHOOLS
2026/2027 Academic Session Home–School Partnership (Nursery 1)



Dear Parent,

Welcome to another exciting academic session at **Cuddles Childminders and Schools**.

We are delighted to have your child as part of our learning community. The Nursery 1 years are an important stage in a child's development, as children become increasingly curious, communicative, independent and eager to explore their world.

At Cuddles, we recognise that **education is most effective when school and home work together**. Our role is to provide a safe, structured and stimulating environment where your child can learn, explore and develop confidence. Your role at home is equally important in reinforcing routines, values, independence and learning habits.

OUR SHARED COMMITMENT

At Cuddles Childminders and Schools, we believe that:

- Every child is unique and deserves to be understood, respected and supported.
- Children learn best through meaningful, hands-on and age-appropriate experiences.
- Independence should be intentionally taught and encouraged.
- Consistent expectations between home and school promote positive behaviour and confidence.
- Academic development must go hand-in-hand with social, emotional, physical and practical development.
- Parents are valued partners in their child's educational journey.

We therefore encourage parents to actively support the routines, expectations and learning experiences outlined below.

** NURSERY 1 LEARNING EXPECTATIONS**

By the end of the academic session, learners will be supported to develop age-appropriate competence in the following areas:

1. Early Numeracy & Cognitive Development

Learners should be able to:

- Count sequentially from **0–200**, with appropriate breaks and support.
- Recognise, trace and write numbers **0–100**, with milestone numbers extending to 150.
- Write number names from **0–10**.
- Identify and sequence the **days of the week and months of the year**.
- Solve simple addition and subtraction problems using concrete objects and visual representations.
- Recognise common Nigerian currency denominations up to **₦100**.
- Identify primary colours and basic shapes.
- Understand basic concepts such as **empty, full and half-full**.
- Connect shapes, colours and characteristics to familiar objects in their environment.
- Identify similarities and differences between objects.
- Demonstrate an emerging understanding of **left and right** and basic positional directions.
- Complete age-appropriate puzzles and construct structures using **8 or more blocks**.

2. Early Literacy & Communication

Learners will be supported to:

- Recognise and write uppercase and lowercase alphabet letters.
- Identify the initial sounds in familiar words.
- Blend sounds to decode simple **3–4 letter words**.
- Spell simple phonically regular words.
- Recognise and produce the **sh** and **th** sounds.
- Write their own names independently.
- Read and write simple sentences appropriate to their developmental level.

- Retell familiar stories in sequence.
- Answer questions about stories, conversations and experiences.
- Develop a vocabulary of approximately **300 words** through meaningful interaction and reading.
- Recite and participate confidently in at least **15 rhymes and songs**.
- Listen attentively and communicate ideas, needs and experiences clearly.

3. Physical & Fine-Motor Development

Learners will develop:

- A functional pencil grip.
- Control when writing or drawing on sand, slates and paper.
- Hand-eye coordination through drawing, colouring, cutting, threading, construction and manipulative activities.
- Gross-motor skills through structured indoor and outdoor play.
- Increasing independence in age-appropriate physical tasks.

4. Personal, Social & Self-Help Skills

Learners are expected to progressively develop independence in:

- Using the toilet with minimal support.
- Putting on and removing shoes.
- Asking appropriately for help when needed.
- Feeding themselves independently.
- Cleaning up after activities and meals.
- Caring for personal belongings.
- Completing simple home-learning activities with minimal adult assistance.
- Following classroom routines and instructions.
- Practising appropriate health, hygiene and safety habits.

Parents are encouraged to **allow children to attempt tasks independently before stepping in to help**. Assistance should be provided where necessary, but over-helping can unintentionally delay the development of independence.

SCHOOL ROUTINES & EXPECTATIONS

School Hours

School Opens: 8:00 a.m.

School Closes: 3:00 p.m.

A **15-minute grace period** is provided after closing time. Thereafter, a **₦1,000 per hour late pick-up charge** applies.

Parents are expected to make reliable arrangements for the timely collection of their children.

School may close due to public holidays, emergencies, government directives or circumstances affecting the health and safety of learners and staff.

DAILY ITEMS

Your child should come to school with:

- A nutritious packed lunch in an insulated food container.
- A healthy fruit snack.
- A labelled water bottle.
- Personal cutlery.
- Breakfast taken **before arriving at school**.
- A medium-sized school bag.
- Any other item specifically requested by the school.

Please label all personal belongings clearly with your child's full name.

Hair & Grooming

Girls should wear simple, neat braids or plaits.

Beads and rubber rings are not permitted because of safety considerations.

All children are expected to arrive at school clean, neatly dressed and appropriately groomed.

ITEMS NOT PERMITTED AT SCHOOL

Unless specifically requested by the school, children should **not** bring:

- Toys
- Candy/sweets
- Biscuits
- Chewing gum
- Juice or sugary drinks
- Money
- Unauthorised food items

These restrictions support healthy habits, reduce distractions and promote a safe and orderly learning environment.

HOMEWORK & PROJECTS

Homework

Homework is designed to reinforce classroom learning and develop good learning habits.

- Homework should generally take **no more than 30 minutes per day**.
- Parents should provide guidance where necessary but should avoid completing tasks for the child.
- Homework contributes to the learner's continuous assessment and should therefore be completed consistently.

Projects

Individual and group projects are an important part of our learning programme.

- Participation is **mandatory**.
- Projects may contribute to continuous assessment.
- Parents may provide resources and reasonable support, but the child's contribution should remain evident.

Our goal is to assess **the child's learning and participation—not the parent's ability to produce a project**.

HEALTH, WELLNESS & SAFETY

The health and safety of every child and member of our school community is a shared responsibility.

A child who is unwell should **remain at home until sufficiently recovered and fit to return to school**.

Parents must notify the school promptly when their child has a contagious illness or condition that may affect other members of the school community.

A doctor's certificate may be requested following prolonged illness or where the school considers medical clearance necessary.

Please do not bring your child to school if they:

- Have a temperature of **38°C or above**.
- Are experiencing repeated vomiting or diarrhoea.
- Have symptoms suggestive of a communicable illness.
- Have chickenpox, measles or another contagious infection.
- Have unexplained or concerning rashes.
- Have conjunctivitis or impetigo.
- Are experiencing significant physical discomfort or distress.
- Have an injury or condition requiring care that cannot safely be provided within the school setting.

Where a child becomes unwell during the school day, the school will contact the parent or authorised emergency contact. The child may be moved to a supervised recovery area while awaiting collection.

Parents are expected to make prompt arrangements for collection when contacted.

MEDICATION

Medication may only be administered in accordance with the school's medication procedures.

All medication must:

- Be clearly labelled with the child's name.
- Be accompanied by appropriate parental instructions/authorisation.
- Be documented through the school's approved communication process.
- Be submitted directly to the designated school personnel where required.

Medication should **not be left in a child's school bag** for self-administration.

HEALTH & HYGIENE HABITS

Parents are encouraged to reinforce the following habits at home:

- Regular handwashing.
- Proper toilet hygiene.
- Covering the mouth and nose when coughing or sneezing.
- Proper disposal of tissues and waste.
- Regular bathing and dental care.
- Keeping personal belongings clean.
- Understanding when to tell an adult that they feel unwell.

These simple habits help children develop lifelong personal-care skills.

PARENT RESPONSIBILITIES & HOME–SCHOOL PARTNERSHIP

A successful Nursery 1 experience requires consistency between home and school.

Parents are expected to:

- Read school communications and respond when necessary.
- Ensure their child arrives at school on time and is collected promptly.
- Support regular attendance.
- Reinforce classroom routines and positive behaviour at home.
- Encourage independence rather than doing everything for the child.
- Support reading, conversation and age-appropriate learning activities at home.
- Attend scheduled parent meetings, conferences and school events.
- Inform the school of relevant changes that may affect the child's wellbeing, learning or behaviour.
- Keep emergency contact and authorised pick-up information current.
- Communicate respectfully and promptly with the school when concerns arise.

SUPPORTING YOUR CHILD AT HOME

Parents can strengthen classroom learning through simple everyday experiences.

You can encourage your child to:

- Count objects around the house.
- Identify colours and shapes.
- Practise writing their name.
- Read age-appropriate books daily.
- Retell stories and describe pictures.
- Identify letters and sounds.
- Sort objects by colour, size or shape.
- Help with simple household tasks.

- Dress and feed themselves where appropriate.
- Pack away toys and personal belongings.
- Use polite words and practise appropriate social interactions.

Everyday activities can become powerful learning opportunities when children are encouraged to participate actively.

FEES, PROPERTY & GENERAL RESPONSIBILITIES

- School fees are expected to be paid within the stipulated payment period.
- Outstanding fees may affect continued access to certain school services or activities.
- Parents may be held financially responsible for deliberate or negligent damage to school property caused by their child.
- Children should be taught to respect school property, shared resources and the belongings of others.
- Parents are encouraged to communicate concerns directly through the appropriate school channels.

Staff Appreciation

To maintain fairness, professionalism and appropriate boundaries, parents are discouraged from giving staff members cash gifts or personal financial incentives.

Kind words, positive feedback and formal recognition are always appreciated.

OUR SHARED GOAL

Our goal is not simply to prepare your child academically.

We want to help develop a child who is:

CURIOUS • CONFIDENT • KIND • INDEPENDENT • RESPONSIBLE • READY TO LEARN

When school and home communicate consistently, children experience greater security, stronger routines and better opportunities to thrive.

Thank you for trusting **Cuddles Childminders and Schools** with this important part of your child's development.

We look forward to a productive, joyful and rewarding academic year together.

Warm regards,

Head of School

Cuddles Childminders and Schools